FOUR-SYLLABLE WORDS

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Four syllables, one strong beat. Check the box under the stressed syllable, then ring every weak syllable whose vowel letter has collapsed into a schwa and write how many you found. Count plain schwas only: not the -le ending, which has no vowel letter in it, and not a vowel sitting in front of an r. Six of these eight words have two.

1.	cel ☐ . e ☐ . bra ☐ . tion ☐	schwas	☐
2.	nec ☐ . es ☐ . sar ☐ . y ☐	schwas	☐
3.	im ☐ . pos ☐ . si ☐ . ble ☐	schwas	☐
4.	mem ☐ . o ☐ . ra ☐ . ble ☐	schwas	☐
5.	in ☐ . vi ☐ . ta ☐ . tion ☐	schwas	☐
6.	pho ☐ . tog ☐ . ra ☐ . pher ☐	schwas	☐
7.	com ☐ . par ☐ . i ☐ . son ☐	schwas	☐
8.	A ☐ . mer ☐ . i ☐ . ca ☐	schwas	☐

Schwa before r. In **photographer** and **comparison** one of the weak vowels sits in front of an r, and so does the one in author, dollar, doctor and sugar. It is the same reduced sound; many teachers call it schwa r and teach it separately, because the r makes the vowel even harder to pin down. Treat these four spellings as a family: -er, -ar, -or, -ur.

The rule of thumb: the longer the word, the more schwas it has, because only one syllable in any English word gets the main stress and everything else is free to reduce.

FOUR-SYLLABLE WORDS ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... Date: .....

Four syllables, one strong beat. Check the box under the stressed syllable, then ring every weak syllable whose vowel letter has collapsed into a schwa and write how many you found. Count plain schwas only: not the -le ending, which has no vowel letter in it, and not a vowel sitting in front of an r. Six of these eight words have two.

1.	cel . e . 'bra . tion	schwas	2
2.	'nec . es . sar . y	schwas	1
3.	im . 'pos . si . ble	schwas	1
4.	'mem . o . ra . ble	schwas	2
5.	in . vi . 'ta . tion	schwas	2
6.	pho . 'tog . ra . pher	schwas	2
7.	com . 'par . i . son	schwas	2
8.	A . 'mer . i . ca	schwas	2

Schwa before r. In **photographer** and **comparison** one of the weak vowels sits in front of an r, and so does the one in author, dollar, doctor and sugar. It is the same reduced sound; many teachers call it schwa r and teach it separately, because the r makes the vowel even harder to pin down. Treat these four spellings as a family: -er, -ar, -or, -ur.

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